Hull vs Hackney

Hull		Hackney
273k	**Population** (2025 estimate, ONS)	266k
#8	**Deprivation** (2025 English IMD rank, of 296)	#27
18.9%	**Council Rented Households** (2021 Census, ONS)	20.7%

Hull vs Hackney

Andy
(Northerner)



Hull		Hackney
273k	**Population** (2025 estimate, ONS)	266k
#8	**Deprivation** (2025 English IMD rank, of 296)	#27
18.9%	**Council Rented Households** (2021 Census, ONS)	20.7%

Boris
(Southerner)



Hull

Average 1-Bed Flat:

Market Rent: **£497**/mo

Council Rent: **£345**/mo



Hackney

Average 1-Bed Flat:

Market Rent: **£1,982**/mo

Council Rent: **£523**/mo



Hull

Average 1-Bed Flat:

Market Rent: **£497**/mo

Council Rent: **£345**/mo

Implicit Subsidy:

£152/mo



Hackney

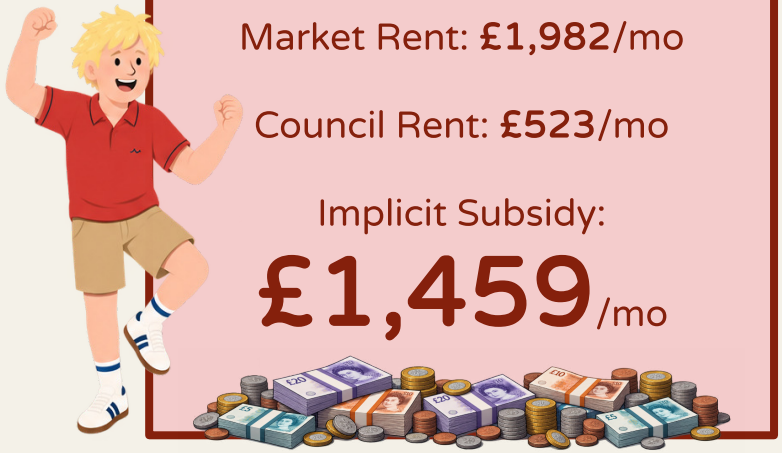
Average 1-Bed Flat:

Market Rent: **£1,982**/mo

Council Rent: **£523**/mo

Implicit Subsidy:

£1,459/mo



Hull
Hackney

Out of Work



+ Up to **£459** in other benefits

£425 UC Allowance

£345 Housing Support

£152 Implicit Subsidy

+ Up to **£466** in other benefits

£425 UC Allowance

£523 Housing Support

Implicit Subsidy:
£1,459



Hull
Hackney

In Work

Loses **39-49%**
of total benefit



Loses **84-89%**
of total benefit

Retains **£152** monthly subsidy

10x

Retains
£1,459
monthly subsidy
for life
under a typical secure tenancy



The Dream

Universalism

Abundance

Integration

Stability

Mobility



The Dream

Universalism

Abundance

Integration

Stability

Mobility

The Nightmare

Exclusion

Scarcity

Segregation

Rigidity

Inertia

> **What is council housing trying to do?** If it is to provide poor tenants with the first rung of a **ladder of opportunity** for either work or housing, it is a **complete failure:** three-quarters claim benefit and stay encamped on the estate

– Will Hutton, *The Observer*, 2007

The Outsider Trap

A person has a **local connection** with the district of a local housing authority if he has a connection with it—

(a) because he is, or in the past was, **normally resident there**, and that residence is or was of his own choice,
(b) because he is **employed there**,
(c) because of **family associations**, or
(d) because of **special circumstances**.

Housing Act 1996, Section 199 (1)

The Outsider Trap

No opportunity

so you need to move elsewhere for work, but you have…



The Outsider Trap

No opportunity

so you need to move elsewhere
for work, but you have…



No money

so you rely on state assistance
for housing, but you have…

The Outsider Trap



Andy
Boris

A Tax on Aspiration



= £29,500/yr
salary uplift

Would need
£79,000/yr
gross salary for parity
(after taxes and housing costs)

£1,459
monthly subsidy

£3,263/mo net
income on median
Hackney salary of
£49,500/yr



The Insider Trap

> The truth is that council housing is a **living tomb**. You dare not give the house up because you might never get another.
>
> – Will Hutton, *The Observer*, 2007
>
> (again)

Why Bother?

"Benefits" Boris



£425 UC Allowance

£523 Housing Support

Implicit Subsidy:
£1,459

Equivalent to
£35,200/yr
gross salary

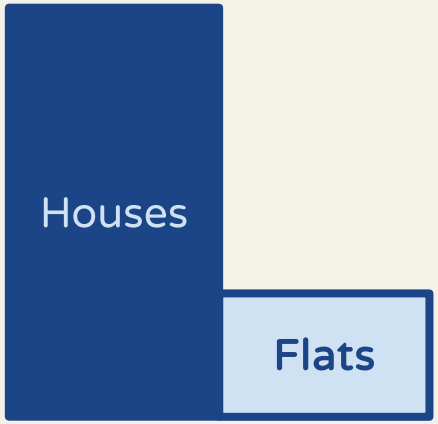
"Bootstraps" Boris

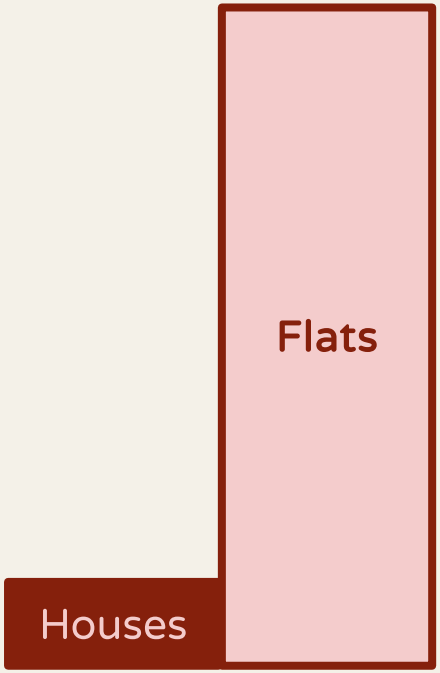


Hull
Hackney

Upstairs, Downstairs









Local Authority Housing Stock by Category

The Bottom Line

*Can **security** and **flexibility** co-exist?*

The Bottom Line

*Can **security** and **flexibility** co-exist?*

*Does **localism** justify **exclusion**?*

The Bottom Line

*Can **security** and **flexibility** co-exist?*

*Does **localism** justify **exclusion**?*

How do we fix this mess?